

DISCOVERY CALL SCRIPT

The AI Inflection Point — Executive Discovery & Risk Conversation

From white-paper lead to locked next step. Built on the Imperion BGRS sales standard.

How to Use This Script

This is a guide, not a teleprompter. Read the situation, stay in business-first language, and keep calm executive confidence throughout. The italicized blue-bar lines are suggested phrasing — adapt them to your voice. The bold fields are what you must capture; fill them in live or immediately after the call.

Eight things you must walk away with: Goals, Priorities, Downtime Cost/Day, Fraud Risk Exposure, Insurance + Compliance Pressure, AI Usage + Shadow AI, Decision Maker + Urgency, and Budget Readiness. If you don't have all eight, you haven't finished discovery.

Non-negotiable standards for this call: Business-first language · Calm executive confidence · Always lock the next step · Always ask for the decision · Document every risk decision · Mandate the SBR cadence.

Pre-Call Prep (5 Minutes)

- Confirm they downloaded / engaged with “The AI Inflection Point” white paper — that’s your opening hook and shared context.
- Pull their public footprint: website, LinkedIn, sector. Note anything that signals fraud exposure (wire transfers, finance team, vendor payments) or compliance pressure (defense, healthcare, financial, energy, water).
- Have the six AI Security Readiness dimensions in front of you: Identity, Endpoint, Network Segmentation, Email & Collaboration, Backup & Recovery, Incident Readiness.
- Decide your target next step before you dial: the AI Security Readiness Assessment.

1. Open & Frame (3–5 min)

Goal: set a calm, peer-level tone. You are an executive risk advisor, not a salesperson chasing a quota. Establish the agenda and earn permission to ask direct questions.

Rapport + reason for the call

“Thanks for making the time. I know your calendar is the scarce resource here, so I’ll be efficient. You took a look at our white paper on how AI is changing the threat landscape — I’d like to spend the next 20 to 25 minutes understanding your business and where your real exposure sits, and then I’ll tell you honestly whether we’re a fit. Fair?”

Set the frame (peer-to-peer, outcome-first)

“My job on this call isn’t to sell you software. It’s to help you see the risk decisions your business is already making — sometimes without realizing it — and then give you a clear,

prioritized picture. You keep that picture whether or not we ever work together. Sound reasonable?”

Capture

Who is on the call / titles:

Engaged with white paper? Y / N — what resonated:

2. Goals & Priorities (5–7 min)

Goal: capture where the business is going and what matters most this year — in their words. Anchor everything later back to these.

“Before we touch anything technical — what are you trying to accomplish as a business over the next 12 months? Growth, a new contract, an acquisition, hiring?”

“And of everything on your plate right now, what are the two or three things that absolutely cannot slip?”

“Where does security or IT sit on that list today — is it a background concern, or has something pushed it up the priority stack recently?”

Capture — Goals

Top business goals (12 mo):

Capture — Priorities

Top 2–3 non-negotiables:

What pushed security up the list (trigger event):

3. Risk & Cost Discovery (10–12 min)

This is the heart of the call. Move through each area conversationally. You are quantifying business risk in dollars and days, not cataloging tools. Document each risk decision as you go — silence or “I don’t know” is itself a finding.

3.1 Downtime Cost / Day

“If your core systems went dark tomorrow — email, files, line-of-business apps — what does a single day of downtime actually cost you? Not just lost revenue, but idle payroll, missed commitments, the scramble.”

“Have you ever put a number to that? Most leaders haven’t until they have to.”

Estimated downtime cost / day: \$

Longest outage they could survive before serious damage:

3.2 Fraud Risk Exposure

“Walk me through how money moves. When a vendor changes their banking details, or your finance lead gets a request to wire funds — what actually has to happen before that money leaves?”

“Could someone convincingly impersonate you or your finance lead today — with an AI-generated email or even a voice call? Because that’s the scenario in the white paper, and it’s now ordinary.”

Wire / payment approval process:

Largest single payment that could go out on one approval: \$

Impersonation / BEC exposure (their words):

3.3 Insurance & Compliance Pressure

“Do you carry cyber-insurance? When you last renewed, did the carrier ask you to attest to specific controls — MFA, endpoint detection, tested backups?”

“Here’s the question that matters: if you had a claim tomorrow and they audited those controls, are you confident every one you signed for is genuinely in place?”

“Any compliance frameworks or customer security requirements you’re held to — CMMC, HIPAA, a client’s vendor questionnaire?”

Cyber-insurance carrier / renewal date:

Controls attested to — confidence they’re met (High / Med / Unknown):

Compliance / customer requirements:

3.4 AI Usage & Shadow AI

“Where is AI already showing up in your business — Copilot, ChatGPT, tools your people brought in on their own?”

“Do you have any visibility or policy around what data goes into those tools? That’s the ‘shadow AI’ piece — usually it’s already happening before leadership decides anything.”

Sanctioned AI tools in use:

Shadow AI / unmanaged usage observed:

Data-governance / AI policy in place? Y / N:

Optional — mirror the white paper self-assessment

If the conversation stalls or they’re analytical, walk them through the six readiness dimensions out loud. Note any “I don’t know” answers — those are your highest-value findings.

Dimension	Quick gut-check question	Their read
Identity Security	Phishing-resistant MFA, not just a code or push?	
Endpoint Security	Consistent patching & hardening across the fleet?	
Network Segmentation	Could one foothold reach everything?	
Email & Collaboration	Microsoft 365 sharing & permissions locked down?	
Backup & Recovery	Backups isolated from ransomware; restore tested?	
Incident Readiness	Written, tested response plan?	

4. Decision, Urgency & Budget (4–5 min)

Goal: qualify cleanly and respectfully. You are not pressuring — you are confirming whether a real decision can be made and on what timeline. Ask directly. Executives respect directness.

Decision maker

“If we lay out a clear plan and it makes sense, who besides you needs to be in the room to move forward?”

Decision maker(s) / others involved:

Urgency

“Is there a clock on this — an insurance renewal, an audit, a contract requirement, a board conversation — or is this you getting ahead of it proactively?”

Driving event + date:

Urgency (Now / This quarter / Exploring):

Budget readiness

“Most organizations your size are already spending on this — often inefficiently, across disconnected tools. Have you set aside a budget for security and IT, or is that part of what we’re figuring out together?”

“I’m not going to quote you a number on a discovery call — that would be irresponsible before we’ve measured anything. But I want to make sure we’re in the same universe before we both invest more time.”

Current security/IT spend or budget posture:

Budget readiness (Allocated / Flexible / None yet):

5. Position the Difference (3–4 min)

Now — and only now, after you understand their world — connect what you heard to how Imperion operates differently. Sell the outcome and the leadership, not the tool stack. Keep it brief; mirror their own words back.

“Here’s what makes us different from the typical IT shop. We don’t hand you software and wish you luck. We run executive-level risk governance for you — we architect it, operate it, and document every decision so you can prove it to an insurer or an auditor. You get the security model of a large enterprise with a local partner who knows your name.”

Tie back to what they told you (fill live):

“You told me _____ matters most, and that _____ is your biggest exposure. Here’s how we’d address exactly that...”

The four things a full-governance partner does

- Runs executive risk governance — security decisions made and owned at the leadership level, not buried in a ticket queue.
- Builds defensibility and documentation — every control evidenced, so insurance attestations and audits hold up.
- Creates a roadmap — a prioritized plan, top remediation steps first, that you keep regardless.
- Mandates Strategic Business Reviews (SBRs) — a recurring leadership cadence where risk, posture, and priorities are reviewed against your goals.

6. Lock the Next Step & Ask for the Decision (3–5 min)

Never end a discovery call without a locked next step and a clear ask. The recommended next step is the AI Security Readiness Assessment — concrete, low-friction, and valuable to them whether or not they become a client.

Recommend the assessment

“Based on what you’ve described, the right next step is our AI Security Readiness Assessment. We meet with your team, deploy lightweight agents to safely scan your environment, and score you across those six dimensions. You walk away with a written report and a prioritized roadmap — top fixes first — and you keep it whether or not we ever work together.”

Ask for the decision (do not skip this)

“Does it make sense to move forward with the assessment?”

Then stop talking. Let them answer.

Lock specifics on the call

Assessment kickoff date / time:

Who from their team participates:

Calendar invite sent before hang-up? Y / N

Mandate the SBR cadence

“One thing I’ll mention now so it’s no surprise: the way we work, we hold a recurring strategic review with you — quarterly — to keep your security posture aligned with where the business is going. That cadence is part of the relationship, not an add-on. I want to make sure that fits how you like to operate.”

SBR cadence agreed (Monthly / Quarterly):

If they hesitate

“Completely fair. Help me understand the hesitation — is it timing, budget, or do you need someone else in the room? Whatever it is, let’s name it so I can be useful.”

Objection / hesitation noted:

Agreed follow-up date + owner:

7. Post-Call Capture (Complete Within 1 Hour)

Document the risk decisions and qualification while it’s fresh. This record is the start of the defensibility trail you’ll maintain for this client.

Discovery Capture	Notes
Goals	
Priorities	
Downtime Cost / Day	
Fraud Risk Exposure	
Insurance + Compliance Pressure	
AI Usage + Shadow AI	
Decision Maker + Urgency	
Budget Readiness	
Risk decisions documented	
Next step locked (what / when)	
SBR cadence agreed	

Qualification verdict

Fit / Not a fit / Nurture — and the one-line reason: